ROOTEDWITHKHETHIWE

School of the Prophets

FOUNDATIONS



LESSON 04 / 05

Steward What You Receive

Be faithful with the entrustment

SCRIPTURE / TEACHING / PRACTICE

Steward What You Receive

READ IN WEB • Matthew 25:14–30 · Luke 16:10–12 · 1 Corinthians 4:1–2 · 1 Peter 4:10

Faithful with what is already in hand

In Matthew 25, the servants receive different amounts and later give an account. Read the parable with attention to what was entrusted, what each person did and how they accounted for it. The talents in the story are sums of money. The conference teaching draws out a wider principle of faithfulness with whatever has been entrusted to us, including time, skill, relationships, influence and spiritual gifts. First Peter 4:10 directs those gifts toward service.

Decide who needs to hear

Some impressions belong in private prayer. Some can be brought to a trusted person for weighing. Others may be shared with the person concerned, with permission and in a form that leaves them free to respond. Think through who could be affected, what you actually know, what your role is, and whether now is a fitting time. A strong feeling of responsibility can be an invitation to pray while you seek clarity about the rest.

Resource stewardship

The conference brings the same question to money. Read Exodus 35:20–29 and observe how materials were contributed willingly for a defined purpose. If an idea touches someone else’s money, time or labour, give them enough information and freedom to decide. Start with what you can account for yourself. A practical inventory might include available time, skills you already have, existing responsibilities and the resources you can use with permission.

Practice and reflection

Practice · Hold, weigh, share or act

You feel prompted to start a prayer gathering for women in your neighbourhood. You also imagine borrowing a hall and asking friends to contribute. Separate the possible invitation to pray from the details you supplied. **Hold** the hall idea until you know the need. **Weigh** the sense of direction with a mature person. **Share** a simple invitation only when there is clarity and consent. **Act** on something within your responsibility, such as praying regularly for the people already in your life.

Keep a stewardship record

Make five entries in your journal: what I perceived, what I think it might mean, who can help me weigh it, what I can faithfully do now, and when I will revisit it. At the review, write what actually happened. If you shared something too strongly, name what you overstated to the person who heard it and give them space to respond.

Journal and pray

What do I already have that could serve someone this week? What am I tempted to rush or announce? Whose trust do I need to protect as I decide what to do?

Father, make me faithful with what You have placed in my hands. Give me wisdom about timing and courage to be accountable for how I use what I receive. Amen.

SOURCE • Prophetic Money speaking notes, Part 2, “Stewardship.”

Scripture readings

Matthew 25:14–30

14 “For it is like a man going into another country, who called his own servants and entrusted his goods to them.

15 To one he gave five talents,to another two, to another one, to each according to his own ability. Then he went on his journey.

16 Immediately he who received the five talents went and traded with them, and made another five talents.

17 In the same way, he also who got the two gained another two.

18 But he who received the one talent went away and dug in the earth and hid his lord’s money.

19 “Now after a long time the lord of those servants came, and settled accounts with them.

20 He who received the five talents came and brought another five talents, saying, ‘Lord, you delivered to me five talents. Behold, I have gained another five talents in addition to them.’

21 “His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a few things, I will set you over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’

22 “He also who got the two talents came and said, ‘Lord, you delivered to me two talents. Behold, I have gained another two talents in addition to them.’

23 “His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant. You have been faithful over a few things. I will set you over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.’

24 “He also who had received the one talent came and said, ‘Lord, I knew you that you are a hard man, reaping where you didn’t sow, and gathering where you didn’t scatter.

25 I was afraid, and went away and hid your talent in the earth. Behold, you have what is yours.’

26 “But his lord answered him, ‘You wicked and slothful servant. You knew that I reap where I didn’t sow, and gather where I didn’t scatter.

27 You ought therefore to have deposited my money with the bankers, and at my coming I should have received back my own with interest.

28 Take away therefore the talent from him and give it to him who has the ten talents.

29 For to everyone who has will be given, and he will have abundance, but from him who doesn’t have, even that which he has will be taken away.

30 Throw out the unprofitable servant into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’

Luke 16:10–12

10 He who is faithful in a very little is faithful also in much. He who is dishonest in a very little is also dishonest in much.

Scripture readings continued

Luke 16:10–12 (continued)

11 If therefore you have not been faithful in the unrighteous mammon, who will commit to your trust the true riches?

12 If you have not been faithful in that which is another's, who will give you that which is your own?

1 Corinthians 4:1–2

1 So let a man think of us as Christ's servants and stewards of God's mysteries.

2 Here, moreover, it is required of stewards that they be found faithful.

1 Peter 4:10

10 As each has received a gift, employ it in serving one another, as good managers of the grace of God in its various forms.

Exodus 35:20–29

20 All the congregation of the children of Israel departed from the presence of Moses.

21 They came, everyone whose heart stirred him up, and everyone whom his spirit made willing, and brought the LORD's offering for the work of the Tent of Meeting, and for all of its service, and for the holy garments.

22 They came, both men and women, as many as were willing-hearted, and brought brooches, earrings, signet rings, and armlets, all jewels of gold; even every man who offered an offering of gold to the LORD.

23 Everyone with whom was found blue, purple, scarlet, fine linen, goats' hair, rams' skins dyed red, and sea cow hides, brought them.

24 Everyone who offered an offering of silver and bronze brought the LORD's offering; and everyone with whom was found acacia wood for any work of the service, brought it.

25 All the women who were wise-hearted spun with their hands, and brought that which they had spun: the blue, the purple, the scarlet, and the fine linen.

26 All the women whose heart stirred them up in wisdom spun the goats' hair.

27 The rulers brought the onyx stones and the stones to be set for the ephod and for the breastplate;

28 with the spice and the oil for the light, for the anointing oil, and for the sweet incense.

29 The children of Israel brought a free will offering to the LORD; every man and woman whose heart made them willing to bring for all the work, which the LORD had commanded to be made by Moses.